Decision-Making

The workhorse of logical decision in most code is the humble `if` statement. There have been numerous examples already throughout the book so far, but there's no harm in revisiting.

`if, else, elseif`

The complete structure consists of the keyword `if` followed by an expression contained in parentheses, which will be evaluated to `true` or `false`. If the result is `true`, execution will pass into a code block contained in braces:

```
if (true) {
    print "true" . PHP_EOL;
}
if (false) {
    print "false" . PHP_EOL;
}
```

```
Output:
true
```

Pretty straightforward stuff. It is possible to specify an alternative block should the `if` expression is `false`, using the `else` keyword…

```
if (false) {
    print "false" . PHP_EOL;
} else {
    print "else" . PHP_EOL;
}
```

```
Output:
else
```

…and even chain together multiple alternative branches with the `elseif` construct:

```
if (false) {
    print "false" . PHP_EOL;
} elseif (true) {
    print "elseif" . PHP_EOL;
```